

Priority and Provenance, version 2

The ARC Principle and the Eden Protocol · Michael Darius Eastwood · programme DOI
10.17605/OSF.IO/6C5XB

Read this first if you are assessing when this work was created. OSF deposit dates are not creation dates. Public deposit began on 17 March 2026; the underlying thesis is cryptographically timestamped from 8 December 2024, fifteen months earlier. The anchors below are independently checkable. This version supersedes the 4 July 2026 record: it corrects the attachment count of the December bundle (five, not four), re-anchors the Eden Protocol name to 8 December 2024, states the timestamp mechanism precisely, and carries, for the first time, the complete priority-claims ledger rather than the anchors alone.

1. The timestamp anchors

DATE	ARTEFACT	ANCHOR
	Self-emailed manuscript bundle: five attachments, 221,236 words (four essays totalling 189,355 words plus the 31,881-word book draft v3.2). Contains U = I x R	
8 Dec 2024, 02:45:1	(Version 2, lines 6 to 9), the control-failure passage (HRIH line 14005), the embedded-correction thesis, and the name Eden Protocol itself (“Chapter 20: The Eden Protocol: Intelligence Born in the Garden”, 31 occurrences in the draft).	.eml SHA-256 fod1f38ffd8546152d9d9d28dc5ec083c16a35858f2c12b63e69db7ed50901ad · Gmail Message-ID CAGPsKAnp-
8 UTC		DLDBOeBAh4t9XsqJBKdoe07uORGF86meoSMFnin7w
	Expanded 562-page draft manuscript. Expands the Eden Protocol; first names Caretaker Doping and Meltdown Triggers; Babylon versus Eden framing (106 / 552 whole-word occurrences).	
30 Apr 2025, 13:37:05 +0100		.eml SHA-256 09f5b5e156ed96f8883eaf668495fd350898ce62be6294b8f788eoe2d6dcb664
	Infinite Architects published in print (ebook 6 Jan 2026). 37 named original concepts; 127	ISBN 978-1806056200

DATE	ARTEFACT	ANCHOR
	verified sources (Appendix E).	
7 Jan 2026	Correspondence to the BBC (Faisal Islam) on the day of the Willow broadcast, the book already published.	.eml original SHA-256 28ada54653d866fc308674cf417bb68015f494fa813f4d28ccec366c9a1ee7b3 (served copy b996883b, redacted for a third party's address)
22 Jan 2026	BBC quantum evidence package, self-sent.	.eml original SHA-256 af863bfa2fc992efc84c656d216894721ef205443774c7804d26907f6fc06c72 (served copy f97e12f5, Drive links redacted)
17 Mar 2026	First OSF deposit of the document suite (a deposit date, not a creation date).	OSF Revisions tabs: version 1 entries dated 17 Mar 2026

What the timestamps establish, stated precisely. A self-sent Gmail message carries Google's server timestamp via its Message-ID and Received trail; that establishes existence-by-date of the exact hashed bytes. The DKIM signature operates in transit and is not preserved by the .eml export, so no claim here is phrased as "DKIM-verified": these are Google-server-timestamped, SHA-256-anchored artefacts, which is the checkable claim.

Where the source emails live. The two self-sent manuscript .emls are held in a companion private component of this project and are available to serious verifiers on request (michael@michaeldariuseastwood.com). The published SHA-256 hashes above verify any provided copy byte for byte. Gating access does not alter evidence: the hash, not the hosting, is the proof.

2. The artefact chain

#	DATE	ARTEFACT	DATE TYPE
1	2024-12-08	8 December 2024 manuscript	Gmail server timestamp on self-sent email carrying the manuscript
2	2025-04-30	30 April 2025 manuscript	Gmail server timestamp on self-sent email
3	2026-01-02	Infinite Architects paperback	Public print publication date
4	2026-01-06	Infinite Architects ebook	Public ebook publication date
5	2026-01-17	Paper I	Public paper release
6	2026-01-22	Paper II	
7	2026-02-09	Paper III	
8	2026-02-13	Foundational paper	
9	2026-02-22	Eden Engineering public note	
10	2026-03-16	Paper IV series	
11	2026-03-16 to 2026-03-	Papers V through IX	

#	DATE	ARTEFACT	DATE TYPE
---	------	----------	-----------

18

3. The complete priority-claims ledger (37 claims)

Machine-readable canonical source: <https://www.michaeldariuseastwood.com/research/priority.json> (version 1.2, 2026-07-31), where each claim carries its full claim text, evidence pointers and risk notes. Categories: timeline (dated events), concepts (named concepts with first-publication dates), findings (results with release dates).

ID	FIRST DATE	CATEGORY	CLAIM
PC-00 1	2024-12- 08	timeline	8 December 2024 self-emailed manuscript as earliest timestamped anchor
PC-00 2	2024-12- 08	concepts	Embedded-correction alignment thesis first stated
PC-00 3	2024-12- 08	concepts	ARC Principle - Artificial Recursive Creation as a named cross-domain framework
PC-00 4	2024-12- 08	concepts	Eden Protocol - precursor description of substrate-embedded alignment governance
PC-00 5	2024-12- 08	concepts	Hyperspace Recursive Intelligence Hypothesis (HRIH)
PC-00 6	2024-12- 09	timeline	Willow first-below-threshold QEC one day after the 8 December 2024 anchor
PC-00 7	2024-12- 18	timeline	AI-control-failure prediction recorded ten days before Anthropic's alignment-faking paper
PC-00 8	2025-01- 20	timeline	DeepSeek R1 thinking-mode release convergent with sequential-recursion anchor
PC-00 9	2025-04- 30	timeline	30 April 2025 manuscript expands the Eden Protocol; first names Caretaker Doping and Meltdown Triggers; Babylon and Eden framing
PC-01 0	2026-01- 02	timeline	Infinite Architects paperback first published 2 January 2026
PC-011 02	2026-01- 02	concepts	ARC Principle equation $U = I \times R^{\alpha}$ formally published as a conjecture
PC-01 2	2026-01- 02	concepts	37 named original concepts of Infinite Architects
PC-01 3	2026-01- 02	concepts	Caretaker Doping - alignment-anchoring mechanism (published concept, TRL 0-1)
PC-01 4	2026-01- 02	concepts	Three-state ethical evaluation (Affirm / Deny / Investigate) as an alignment application framing

ID	FIRST DATE	CATEGORY	CLAIM
PC-01 5	2026-01- 02	concepts	Three Ethical Loops - nested-loop alignment architecture
PC-01 6	2026-01- 02	concepts	Semiconductor Chokepoint Mechanism
PC-01 7	2026-01- 02	concepts	HARI Treaty proposal
PC-01 8	2026-01- 02	concepts	Meltdown Alignment
PC-01 9	2026-01- 02	concepts	Monitoring Removal Test
PC-02 0	2026-01- 02	concepts	Orchard Caretaker Vow
PC-02 1	2026-01- 02	concepts	Infinite Covenant
PC-02 2	2026-01- 06	timeline	Infinite Architects ebook edition first published 6 January 2026
PC-02 3	2026-01- 07	timeline	BBC broadcast of Willow and parallel universes with Hartmut Neven five days after paperback
PC-02 4	2026-01- 17	timeline	OSF programme DOI issued and Paper I first released 17 January 2026
PC-02 5	2026-01- 22	timeline	Paper II experimental validation first released 22 January 2026
PC-02 6	2026-01- 22	findings	Parallel-recursion sub-linear scaling exponent α_{parallel} approximately zero
PC-02 7	2026-01- 22	findings	Initial sequential exponent estimate $\alpha_{\text{sequential}}$ approximately 2.24 - formally retracted
PC-02 8	2026-01- 22	findings	Revised robust sequential-recursion exponent $\alpha_{\text{sequential}}$ approximately 0.49 (sub-linear)
PC-02 9	2026-01- 22	findings	Sequential > parallel fundamental inequality across tested models
PC-03 0	2026-01- 22	findings	Six-frontier-model empirical panel design (Claude, DeepSeek, Gemini, Grok, Groq Qwen, GPT)
PC-03 1	2026-02- 09	concepts	Paper III released - Alignment Scaling Problem formalisation
PC-03 2	2026-02- 09	findings	Capability-alignment independence finding

ID	FIRST DATE	CATEGORY	CLAIM
PC-03 3	2026-02- 09	findings	Three-tier alignment hierarchy
PC-03 4	2026-02- 13	timeline	ARC Principle foundational cross-domain paper released 13 February 2026
PC-03 5	2026-02- 13	findings	Cross-domain recursive-amplification convergence across four independent programmes
PC-03 6	2026-02- 13	findings	Application of the bare $\alpha = d / (d + 1)$ scaling exponent to recursive AI capability
PC-03 7	2026-02- 22	timeline	Eden Engineering research note released 22 February 2026; expanded specification withdrawn 14 July 2026

4. What is claimed, and what is not

Priority is claimed only for what the anchored artefacts contain on their timestamped dates. The 8 December 2024 control-failure passage establishes the structural thesis ten days before Anthropic’s alignment-faking result (Greenblatt et al., arXiv:2412.14093, 18 December 2024); no claim is made to their specific RL-training mechanism, and any citation of their 78 per cent figure carries both the RL-training condition and the 12 per cent baseline. Where independent researchers reached related results, credit runs to them wherever their dates require it: the register classes such rows concurrent or prior art explicitly (Sharma and Chopra on the quantified sequential result; Kitaev and Preskill on quantum error correction; 01 preceding the manuscript on deployed sequential reasoning). The convergence register stands at 26 dated events as at 31 July 2026, of which 22 are claimed as independent convergence and 4 are disclosed and not claimed. This document establishes when this author’s artefacts existed; it does not assert that no one else has reasoned about recursion, correction, or scaling.

5. How the files are organised

Canonical files at OSF Storage root carry no version number; each file’s history is its Revisions tab. Uploading a corrected file under the same name adds a version, never overwrites. The archive folder holds superseded early drafts under their original names. Nothing is deleted; superseded material moves to archive.

Version 2 · 31 July 2026 · Michael Darius Eastwood · verify, don’t believe.